

INDUSTRY-READY AI HANDBOOK

How Every Industry Is Being Transformed by Artificial Intelligence

Real Companies. Real Use Cases. Real Impact.

A companion resource for the ET Masterclass: AI for Business Professionals

Prepared exclusively for masterclass attendees | 2026 Edition

Welcome to the AI Revolution

AI is no longer a technology story. It is a business story. Across every industry — from banking halls in Mumbai to hospital wards in Chennai, from factory floors in Pune to hotel lobbies in Goa — artificial intelligence is quietly and profoundly changing how work gets done, how decisions are made, and how businesses compete.

This handbook is your guided tour through that transformation. It is designed for business professionals — not data scientists. You will not find technical jargon here. What you will find is real companies, doing real things with AI, right now, across the industries that matter to you.

How to use this handbook

Find your industry. Read what AI is already doing there. Then ask: what is my business missing? Each section ends with a practical question you can bring back to your team tomorrow.

Industries Covered in This Handbook

Industry	Page Theme
 Manufacturing & Automotive	From factory floor defects to self-driving design
 Hospitals & Healthcare	Diagnosis, drug discovery, and patient care

 Banking & Finance	Fraud, lending, and the future of money
 e-Commerce & Retail Stores	Personalisation, logistics, and visual search
 Hotels & Hospitality	Guest experience, dynamic pricing, smart rooms
 FMCG & D2C Brands	Demand forecasting, content at scale, personalisation
 Real Estate & Construction	Valuations, site intelligence, automated bidding
 Media & Marketing	Content creation, campaign automation, audience AI
 IT Firms & Consulting	Agentic AI, code generation, client intelligence
 Oil & Energy Sectors	Predictive maintenance, grid optimisation, safety

The Most Important Insight in This Handbook

AI does not replace industries. It separates the businesses that adapt from the businesses that disappear. Every company in this handbook was once doing things the old way. They chose to move. The question is: will you?



01 | Manufacturing & Automotive

The Big Picture

Manufacturing was the first industry to be automated — and it is the first to be intelligently automated. The difference is enormous. Old automation followed fixed rules. AI-powered manufacturing learns, adapts, and improves. A robot on an assembly line replaces one task. An AI system on an assembly line redesigns the entire process.

Market size: AI in manufacturing will hit \$155 billion by 2030, growing at 35% annually. Today, 1 in 4 vehicles manufactured includes AI features.

What AI Is Doing Right Now

- **Predictive Maintenance:** Sensors on machines detect micro-vibrations, temperature changes, and acoustic anomalies — before a breakdown happens. Siemens deploys this across global plants, reducing unplanned downtime by up to 50%.
- **Quality Inspection:** Computer vision cameras inspect products at 10,000 per hour with 99%+ accuracy — catching defects invisible to the human eye. Volkswagen Group runs 1,200+ AI applications across their production network.
- **Generative Design:** AI generates thousands of design variations for a component and selects the one with optimal strength, weight, and cost. BMW's Neue Klasse platform uses AI to design parts that reduce vehicle weight by 15–30%.
- **Supply Chain Intelligence:** AI predicts demand fluctuations, reroutes logistics around disruptions, and reduces inventory waste. Ford deploys AI across its global supply chain, combined with Microsoft Sentinel for security.

- Autonomous Robots (Cobots): AI-powered collaborative robots work safely alongside humans, adapting to dynamic environments. Rockwell Automation integrated NVIDIA AI into their Otto mobile robots.

Real Companies Doing It

Volkswagen Group volkswagen-group.com

1,200+ AI applications active across the entire group — from design to cybersecurity

What they do: Running AI in vehicle development, production quality, supply chain, and knowledge management across all brands including Audi, Porsche, and Škoda.

Business impact: Audi's 'Tender Toucan' AI reduced bid analysis time for suppliers significantly. Their Edge Cloud 4 Production platform reduced hardware requirements on factory floors while enabling faster feature deployment.

Siemens siemens.com

AI-powered digital twin simulation meets real-world factory operations

What they do: Siemens integrates AI into their PAVE360 digital twin environment, enabling automotive engineers to simulate vehicle performance before building a single physical prototype. Their Teamcenter AI analyses voice content in multiple languages to auto-generate engineering reports.

Business impact: Reduces physical prototype costs by 30–50% and shortens R&D cycles. Their predictive maintenance deployments cut unplanned failures and maintenance costs significantly.

Tata Elxsi (India) tataelxsi.com

India's leading AI-driven engineering and design company

What they do: Provides AI solutions for autonomous vehicle intelligence, medical imaging diagnostics, and AI-powered OTT content recommendation engines. Applies predictive maintenance and intelligent automation for manufacturing and automotive clients globally.

Business impact: Works with global OEMs to integrate AI into vehicle ADAS systems and infotainment. Enables Indian manufacturers to access world-class AI engineering capability at local scale.

The Question for Your Business

If a machine in your factory fails tomorrow, will you know about it today? Predictive maintenance pays for itself within 6–18 months for most manufacturers. What is one machine in your operation where a breakdown is most costly?



02 | Hospitals & Healthcare

The Big Picture

Healthcare AI is not about replacing doctors. It is about giving doctors a superpower. A radiologist can read 70 X-rays a day. An AI system reads 70,000 — and flags the ones that need urgent human attention. In India, where there is 1 doctor per 1,445 people, this is not a luxury. It is an emergency solution.

⚡ The Scale of the Opportunity

India has 600,000+ villages. Most have no radiologist, no pathologist, no specialist. AI can deliver diagnostic-grade intelligence to a mobile phone in any one of them. That is not technology. That is access.

What AI Is Doing Right Now

- **Medical Imaging Diagnosis:** AI reads X-rays, CT scans, and MRIs with accuracy matching senior radiologists. It detects TB, lung cancer, strokes, and fractures in seconds.
- **Early Cancer Detection:** Thermal imaging AI screens for breast cancer without radiation or physical contact — making screening accessible in rural areas.
- **Drug Discovery:** AI models predict which molecular compounds will be effective against diseases, cutting drug discovery from 12 years to under 4 in early trials.
- **Wearable Health Monitoring:** AI-powered wearables track biomarkers continuously, detecting cardiac anomalies, oxygen levels, and stress patterns before symptoms appear.
- **Clinical Documentation:** AI transcribes doctor-patient conversations and auto-fills clinical notes, saving doctors 2–3 hours per day of administrative work.
- **Predictive Patient Risk:** AI scores patients for readmission risk, sepsis probability, and deterioration — enabling proactive intervention before a crisis.

Real Companies Doing It

Qure.ai qure.ai

Deep learning that reads medical images and saves lives at scale

What they do: Qure.ai's AI interprets X-rays, CT scans, and MRIs in seconds. It specialises in early detection of tuberculosis, lung cancer, stroke, and fractures. Their platform is deployed in 90+ countries including hospitals, clinics, and mobile screening vans in India's most underserved regions.

Business impact: Automates routine diagnostic tasks so doctors focus on patient care. Enables screening at 10–15x lower cost than traditional radiology. In TB detection, Qure.ai matches or exceeds senior radiologist accuracy — critical in India where TB kills 480,000 people annually.

Niramai (India) niramai.com

Radiation-free AI breast cancer screening for rural India

What they do: Niramai uses thermal imaging combined with machine learning to detect early-stage breast cancer. Unlike mammography, it requires no radiation, no physical

contact, and no radiologist on-site — making it deployable in mobile vans and rural health camps.

Business impact: Founder Geetha Manjunath's platform has raised \$8.63M and is expanding across India. The technology enables early detection where no detection previously existed.

Neosapien — Wearable AI shop.neosapien.xyz

The AI health companion you wear, not just carry

What they do: Neosapien builds wearable AI technology that continuously monitors biometric data — tracking health indicators, activity, and performance metrics. Their devices integrate AI models that learn your personal baseline and alert you to deviations before they become problems.

Business impact: Positions users to move from reactive healthcare (seeing a doctor when sick) to proactive health management (acting before symptoms appear). Particularly relevant for high-performance professionals and athletes.

SigTuple (India) sigtuple.com

AI-powered pathology at the microscope level

What they do: SigTuple's Manthana platform digitises microscopy images and processes them with AI to generate diagnostic reports for blood and urine tests — without a pathologist in the room. Achieves 95%+ accuracy in complete blood count testing.

Business impact: Brings diagnostic access to cities and towns that previously had no qualified pathologist. Reduces diagnosis time from days to minutes for routine blood work.



The Question for Your Business

If you run or invest in hospitals, clinics, or diagnostics — what percentage of your patients are being seen at a stage when intervention is still affordable? AI-driven early detection changes the economics of healthcare from treatment to prevention.



03 | Banking & Finance

The Big Picture

Banking has always been an information business. The bank that best understands risk, behaviour, and opportunity wins. AI processes information at a scale no human team can match — and it does it in real time, across millions of transactions simultaneously. The Indian BFSI sector is one of the most active adopters of AI in the world.

What AI Is Doing Right Now

- **Fraud Detection:** AI monitors every transaction in real time, building behavioural models for each customer and flagging anomalies instantly. False positives drop, genuine fraud stops.
- **Credit Scoring:** AI analyses alternative data — mobile usage patterns, utility payments, e-commerce history — to extend credit to the 190 million Indians who lack traditional credit histories.
- **KYC & Onboarding:** AI verifies identity documents, detects fake IDs, and cross-references databases in under 60 seconds. What once took 3 days in a branch now happens on a phone.
- **Conversational Banking:** AI voice agents handle account queries, card blocks, and loan applications in regional Indian languages — 24/7, at a fraction of the cost of call centres.
- **Risk & Regulatory Compliance:** AI reads regulatory circulars (RBI, SEBI, IRDAI) and automatically flags compliance gaps in internal policies — work that previously took teams of lawyers weeks.
- **Wealth Management:** AI generates personalised portfolio recommendations, rebalances assets based on market signals, and produces client-ready reports automatically.

Real Companies Doing It

Arya.ai (India) arya.ai

Regulatory-compliant AI built for Indian BFSI

What they do: Arya.ai offers a platform that helps banks and insurers deploy complex deep learning models within India's regulatory framework. Their AI handles fraud detection, credit risk, document processing, and customer analytics.

Business impact: Enables BFSI institutions to move from rule-based to adaptive AI models. Their regulatory compliance layer is built specifically for RBI, SEBI, and IRDAI guidelines — critical for Indian financial institutions.

Signzy (India) signzy.com

AI-powered digital identity verification at bank-grade security

What they do: Signzy automates identity verification, fraud detection, and digital customer onboarding using AI and machine learning. Their platform verifies documents, detects deepfakes, and cross-references government databases in real time.

Business impact: Used by HDFC Bank, ICICI, Axis, and 50+ financial institutions. Reduces onboarding time from 3 days to under 3 minutes while reducing fraud-related losses significantly.

Gnani.ai (India) gnani.ai

Voice AI for banking in 17+ Indian languages

What they do: Gnani.ai specialises in speech recognition, voice biometrics, and multilingual voice automation. Their platform enables banks and telecoms to deploy AI call agents that handle customer queries, authenticate callers using voice, and detect fraud — in Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, and more.

Business impact: Reduces call centre costs by up to 60% while improving response times and accuracy. Enables regional language banking access for the first time in many underserved markets.

Fractal Analytics (India) fractal.ai

Decision intelligence for Fortune 500 financial institutions

What they do: Fractal provides AI-powered consumer insights and decision intelligence. In financial services, their AI models handle predictive risk assessment, fraud detection, and customer lifetime value modelling for global banks and insurers.

Business impact: Works with Fortune 500 financial companies globally. Their Qure.ai division (healthcare) and Cuddle (business intelligence) demonstrate the breadth of India's AI capability at enterprise scale.



The Question for Your Business

How many of your loan rejections are based on thin credit files rather than genuine risk? And how many fraudulent transactions slipped through last quarter because your rules-based system was not adaptive? AI addresses both simultaneously.



04 | e-Commerce & Retail Stores

The Big Picture

The modern e-commerce battle is not about who has the most products. It is about who understands the customer best. Amazon's AI recommendation engine generates 35% of all its revenue. That is not a feature — it is the business model. And the same capability is now available to every D2C brand, every kiriyana chain, and every marketplace seller in India.

What AI Is Doing Right Now

- **Personalised Recommendations:** AI analyses browsing history, purchase patterns, and real-time behaviour to surface the exact product a customer wants — before they search for it.
- **Visual Search:** Customers photograph a product they see in the real world and find it instantly on a platform. Myntra, Meesho, and Flipkart have all deployed visual search.
- **Dynamic Pricing:** AI adjusts prices in real time based on demand, competitor pricing, inventory levels, and customer willingness-to-pay — optimising margin and velocity simultaneously.
- **Demand Forecasting:** AI predicts which SKUs will sell, where, and when — reducing overstock by 20–30% and stockouts by 40–50% for India's largest FMCG distributors.
- **AI-Powered Customer Support:** Conversational AI handles returns, exchanges, tracking queries, and complaints across WhatsApp, email, and chat — with zero wait time, 24/7.
- **Intelligent Logistics:** AI route-optimisation engines (Locus, Shippy) reduce last-mile delivery costs by 15–25% and improve on-time delivery to 98%+.

Real Companies Doing It

Attentive.com attentive.com

Agentic AI for personalised SMS and email marketing at scale

What they do: Attentive's AI platform, trained on 1.4 trillion data points across 40+ billion messages, deploys intelligent marketing agents that identify website visitors, personalise messages across SMS, email, and RCS, and automate entire campaigns. Their Magic Message feature generates AI-written copy and AI-modified product images for each campaign.

Business impact: Brands report identifying far more abandoned cart customers and significantly higher conversion on recovery flows versus previous providers. One client saw 'insane' improvements in abandoned email recovery within two months of switching.

Locus (India) locus.sh

AI-powered logistics intelligence for FMCG and e-commerce

What they do: Locus provides AI decision-making and route optimisation for last-mile delivery. Their algorithms process real-time traffic, driver availability, delivery schedules, and vehicle constraints to cut delivery costs by 15–25% while achieving 98%+ on-time delivery.

Business impact: Used by Unilever, Nestle, Bluedart, and Shadowfax across India and Southeast Asia. One of India's most successful AI logistics companies with global client deployment.

Yellow.ai (India) yellow.ai

Enterprise conversational AI for customer engagement at scale

What they do: Yellow.ai deploys multilingual AI agents across WhatsApp, web, and mobile to automate customer support, lead qualification, and e-commerce assistance. Their platform handles millions of conversations simultaneously in 135+ languages.

Business impact: Raised \$102M in funding. Used by Domino's, Waste Connections, Hyundai, and hundreds of enterprises globally to automate customer engagement and reduce support costs by 40–60%.



The Question for Your Business

What percentage of your website visitors are you converting? And of those who abandon their cart, how many are you recovering? AI-powered personalisation and recovery flows can increase e-commerce revenue by 15–35% without a single additional rupee in acquisition spend.



05 | Hotels & Hospitality

The Big Picture

The hotel industry runs on two things: experience and margin. AI is the only tool that improves both simultaneously. A hotel that uses AI to personalise the guest experience increases repeat bookings. A

hotel that uses AI to optimise pricing and staffing improves margin. The hotels winning in 2026 are doing both — quietly, invisibly, continuously.

Scale: U.S. hotel guest spending is expected to reach \$805 billion in 2026. Hotel groups deploying AI revenue optimisation across portfolios are reporting cluster RevPAR gains of 10–15%.

What AI Is Doing Right Now

- **Dynamic Revenue Management:** AI adjusts room prices in real time based on booking curves, local events, competitor rates, weather, and 100+ demand signals — simultaneously, for every room type.
- **Personalised Guest Experience:** AI recognises returning guests and pre-loads their preferences — pillow type, room temperature, dietary restrictions, preferred floor — before they even check in.
- **AI Concierge & Chatbots:** Guests message the hotel on WhatsApp or the hotel app and receive instant, contextual responses in multiple languages. Room service, requests, complaints — all handled automatically.
- **Smart Energy Management:** AI controls HVAC, lighting, and energy systems based on real-time occupancy. Nordic chain Scandic's AI energy system saves millions annually across its estate.
- **Workforce & Staffing Optimisation:** AI forecasts occupancy and automatically schedules the right number of staff — reducing labour cost overruns during slow periods and service gaps during peaks.
- **Food Waste Reduction:** AI tracks kitchen inventory and consumption, optimises purchasing, and reduces food waste — a significant cost and sustainability win for food-heavy hospitality operations.

Real Companies Doing It

Marriott / Hilton / IHG marriott.com

Global chains leading AI-powered personalisation and revenue management

What they do: Major chains are deploying AI revenue management systems that learn from 10+ years of booking data, event calendars, competitor signals, and real-time demand. Marriott has integrated Amazon Alexa into room experiences for voice-activated concierge services.

Business impact: Hotels running AI revenue management systems report 10–15% RevPAR improvement. AI-powered upsell engines increase ancillary revenue per booking through personalised pre-arrival offers (room upgrades, spa packages, late checkout).

SevenRooms sevenrooms.com

AI guest intelligence platform for restaurants and hotels

What they do: SevenRooms connects PMS, CRM, reservations, and marketing into a unified AI view of each guest. Their platform enables personalised communication throughout the guest journey — pre-arrival, in-stay, and post-stay — driving upgrades, upsells, and retention.

Business impact: The Island Quarter in Nottingham generated £33,000 in upgrade and prepayment revenue in six months with a 10% retention improvement using SevenRooms. Proven at scale across independent and chain properties.

Mews (PMS + AI) mews.com

The operating system for the AI-powered hotel

What they do: Mews powers 12,500+ properties across 85 countries. Their platform connects PMS, revenue management, guest messaging, and sustainability tracking into a single AI-informed system. Their 2026 Hospitality Outlook report identified AI-readiness as the key differentiator for hotel competitiveness.

Business impact: Properties using Mews report improved operational clarity, reduced manual reconciliation, and faster guest service delivery. Their open API enables integration with AI tools across the hotel tech stack.



The Question for Your Business

If you run a hotel or hospitality property — do you know which guest segments are most likely to accept an upsell offer before arrival? And are you pricing your rooms differently on the same night based on the booking source? These are table-stakes AI applications in 2026.



06 | FMCG & D2C Brands

The Big Picture

FMCG brands live and die by two numbers: share of shelf and share of wallet. AI is rewriting both. Demand forecasting AI prevents stockouts that cost brands billions. Content generation AI lets a 5-person D2C team produce the same volume of creative assets as a 50-person agency. And personalisation AI turns one-time buyers into loyal customers.

What AI Is Doing Right Now

- **Demand Forecasting:** AI analyses historical sales, weather, festivals, social media trends, and competitor activity to predict demand at SKU level — reducing overstock and eliminating stockouts.
- **AI Product Visualisation:** Brands use AI image generation to create professional product photography, lifestyle imagery, and campaign visuals in minutes — without a studio or photographer.
- **Consumer Sentiment Analysis:** AI monitors millions of social media posts, reviews, and forum discussions to surface brand perception, emerging complaints, and category trends in real time.
- **Personalised Marketing:** AI segments audiences at the individual level and personalises messages, offers, and timing across SMS, email, WhatsApp, and social — increasing conversion by 20–40%.

- Voice and Influencer Intelligence: AI analyses creator content at scale to identify the right influencer partnerships, predict campaign performance, and measure ROI across 1,000+ creators simultaneously.
- Supply Chain Optimisation: AI manages raw material procurement, production scheduling, and distributor allocation — reducing supply chain costs by 10–20% for major FMCG players.

Real Companies Doing It

Hindustan Unilever (India) hul.co.in

India's largest FMCG company deploying AI at every stage of the value chain

What they do: HUL uses AI for demand sensing across 6,500+ SKUs, AI-generated content for digital campaigns, sentiment analysis across social platforms, and AI-powered distribution optimisation across its network of 2.7 million retail outlets.

Business impact: AI demand forecasting has reduced waste and improved service levels across HUL's supply chain. Their AI content initiatives allow marketing teams to produce regional language adaptations of campaigns in days rather than weeks.

Mamaearth / Honasa Consumer (India) mamaearth.in

India's fastest-growing D2C brand built on data intelligence

What they do: Mamaearth uses AI to track consumer sentiment across beauty and skincare categories, identify ingredient trends before they peak, personalise digital marketing at customer level, and optimise content spend across channels.

Business impact: Built a Rs 1,900 crore revenue brand in under 10 years by combining AI-informed product development with precision digital marketing. Their AI analytics capability gives them a significant edge in understanding Gen Z and millennial consumer behaviour.

Entropik (India) entropik.io

AI that understands human emotion and consumer behaviour

What they do: Entropik uses AI to analyse facial expressions, eye tracking, voice, and physiological responses to understand how consumers react to packaging, advertisements, product names, and brand experiences — before launch.

Business impact: FMCG brands use Entropik to test packaging redesigns, ad concepts, and new product ideas in weeks rather than months. Reduces the risk of costly launch failures by understanding consumer emotional response accurately.

The Question for Your Business

How long does it take your team to produce a new creative asset for a regional campaign? If the answer is more than 48 hours, AI image generation and content tools can eliminate 80% of that time — while your team focuses on strategy instead of production.



The Big Picture

Real estate is a \$3.3 trillion industry globally that has been powered by manual processes, gut-feel valuations, and relationship networks. AI is changing all three. Property valuations now happen in minutes. Construction bids that took days to prepare take minutes. And buyers find their ideal property before they even know they are looking.

What AI Is Doing Right Now

- **Property Valuation:** AI analyses thousands of comparable transactions, location data, infrastructure proximity, and micro-market trends to generate instant, accurate valuations — replacing 2-week manual appraisals.
- **Construction Takeoffs & Bidding:** AI reads blueprints and aerial imagery to automatically calculate material quantities for bids — a process that previously took estimators 40+ hours per bid.
- **Virtual Staging & Visualisation:** AI transforms empty construction-phase photos into furnished, styled interiors — helping buyers visualise completed units and reducing time-to-booking.
- **Legal Due Diligence:** AI reads property title documents, encumbrance certificates, and RERA filings to identify ownership disputes, legal risks, and compliance gaps in minutes.
- **Predictive Maintenance for Buildings:** AI monitors building systems (HVAC, electrical, plumbing) in real estate portfolios and predicts failures before they occur — reducing maintenance costs for large operators.
- **Lead Qualification:** AI voice agents handle property enquiries 24/7, qualify leads based on budget, timeline, and location preference, and route warm leads to sales teams.

Real Companies Doing It

Attentive.ai (Construction) attentive.ai

AI that automates construction takeoffs and eliminates bidding waste

What they do: Attentive.ai's Beam AI platform reads blueprints and aerial imagery to generate fully automated construction takeoffs across electrical, mechanical, plumbing, concrete, civil, and 10+ other trades. Founded in Delhi by IIT alumni and backed by Peak XV Partners, Vertex Ventures, and InfoEdge Ventures.

Business impact: Clients report cutting bid preparation time by 70–90%. Monarch Landscape sent 40% more bids and increased win rates by 5–10%. Pilkington Construction achieved 1.5x business growth. H&H Striping doubled bid volume. Trusted by 1,200+ contractors across the US and Canada.

Landeed (India — YC Backed) landeed.in

AI-native property intelligence and title verification platform

What they do: Landeed provides AI-powered property intelligence covering title search, legal due diligence, collateral verification, and property payment infrastructure. Their Terra property intelligence engine converts fragmented land records across 24 Indian states into structured, queryable data — legal-grade due diligence in minutes rather than weeks.

Business impact: Trusted by Fortune India 500 companies across BFSI, real estate, and retail. Enables banks to verify property collateral instantly during loan processing — a process that previously delayed disbursements by days.

NoBroker (India) nobroker.in

AI-powered property matching without intermediaries

What they do: NoBroker uses AI to match buyers and renters directly with property owners, eliminating broker fees. Their AI analyses property preferences, lifestyle factors, and commute patterns to surface the most relevant listings. AI chatbots handle enquiries and scheduling.

Business impact: India's first prop-tech unicorn. Has facilitated millions of transactions worth billions of rupees. Their AI matching engine significantly outperforms traditional search in conversion rate.



The Question for Your Business

If you are in construction — how many bids did you miss last quarter because your estimating team ran out of time? AI-automated takeoffs can double your bid volume without adding a single estimator. That is directly more revenue opportunity.



08 | Media & Marketing

The Big Picture

Marketing has always been about reaching the right person with the right message at the right time. AI makes this not just possible but automatic. A marketing team of 5 with AI can outperform a team of 50 without it — producing more content, running more experiments, and converting more customers. The agencies and brands that understand this early will dominate.

What AI Is Doing Right Now

- **Content Generation at Scale:** AI writes blog posts, social captions, email copy, product descriptions, and ad scripts — in brand voice, in regional languages, at 100x the speed of human teams.
- **AI Image & Video Production:** AI generates campaign visuals, product photography, and video ads from a single product image — eliminating studio costs and enabling unlimited creative variations.
- **Audience Intelligence:** AI analyses first-party data, social signals, and purchase behaviour to create micro-segments that go beyond demographics — enabling true 1:1 personalisation.

- Performance Prediction: AI predicts which creative assets will perform best before a campaign goes live — based on historical performance data across millions of similar ads.
- Programmatic + AI Buying: AI optimises ad spend in real time across channels, automatically shifting budget to the highest-performing placements and pausing underperforming ones.
- Creator Economy Intelligence: AI analyses creator audiences, engagement authenticity, and brand safety to identify the right influencer partnerships and predict campaign outcomes.

Real Companies Doing It

Attentive.com — AI Marketing attentive.com

Agentic AI trained on 1.4 trillion marketing data points

What they do: Attentive's Magic Message uses AI to generate personalised SMS and email copy, modify product images for campaigns, and automatically build multi-channel campaigns from a single click. Their Automated Campaigns feature learns from the highest-performing moments across 70+ verticals and replicates them for your brand.

Business impact: Brands report dramatically higher abandoned cart recovery, more customers identified per campaign, and significantly better conversion rates. One Director of Customer Retention called the results 'insane' compared to their previous provider.

NeuralGarage (India) neuralgarage.com

Generative AI for audiovisual media production

What they do: NeuralGarage builds VisualDub — an AI tool that automatically syncs dubbed audio with facial expressions in video content. This enables media creators and brands to localise video content for regional Indian languages without re-shooting.

Business impact: Solves one of Indian media's biggest challenges: reaching audiences in 20+ languages cost-effectively. Enables content produced in one language to be adapted for all Indian markets in hours.

Uniphore (India) uniphore.com

Conversational AI and emotion intelligence for enterprise sales

What they do: Uniphore offers conversational AI that analyses sales and customer service calls in real time — detecting emotion, intent, and compliance gaps. Their AI provides live coaching to agents and generates post-call summaries automatically.

Business impact: AI unicorn with enterprise clients globally. Reduces call handling time by 30–40%, improves first-call resolution, and provides marketing teams with accurate voice-of-customer intelligence from thousands of calls simultaneously.

The Question for Your Business

How many creative variations did your team A/B test in your last campaign? If the answer is fewer than 10, you are leaving conversion on the table. AI enables 100+ variations with zero additional production cost — letting the data choose the winner instead of your gut.



09 | IT Firms & Consulting

The Big Picture

The consulting and IT industry faces an extraordinary paradox: it is the sector most equipped to understand AI and the one most disrupted by it. An AI that codes, analyses, and generates reports replaces the foundational work of thousands of junior consultants and developers. The firms winning in 2026 are those that have moved their people up the value chain — using AI to do the grunt work so humans can do the thinking.

What AI Is Doing Right Now

- **AI Code Generation:** Tools like Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Cursor are writing 30–80% of code in many engineering teams — reducing development time by 40–70% for common features.
- **Agentic Research:** AI agents autonomously research topics, read documents, synthesise findings, and produce client-ready reports — replacing weeks of junior analyst work in hours.
- **Client Intelligence:** AI processes CRM data, email threads, meeting transcripts, and project files to surface account risks, upsell opportunities, and relationship health scores.
- **Proposal & Pitch Generation:** AI drafts RFP responses, capability presentations, and proposal documents from a brief — ensuring consistency and freeing senior consultants for strategy.
- **Knowledge Management:** AI builds searchable institutional knowledge bases from past engagement documents, research reports, and methodology files — so every team member has access to the firm's collective intelligence.
- **AI-Powered HR & Talent:** AI screens CVs at scale, predicts flight risk for high performers, and suggests internal mobility opportunities — critical for consulting firms with high attrition rates.

Real Companies Doing It

Fabric AI — HR Platform fabrichq.ai

AI that transforms how modern organisations manage their people

What they do: Fabric AI is an intelligent HR platform that uses AI to streamline talent acquisition, employee engagement, performance management, and people analytics. Their platform learns from company-specific patterns to predict attrition, suggest promotions, and identify skills gaps before they become business risks.

Business impact: Enables HR teams to scale people intelligence without scaling headcount. Particularly relevant for IT and consulting firms that lose 20–30% of their workforce annually and need faster, smarter hiring and retention tools.

Infosys / Wipro / TCS (India) infosys.com

India's IT giants racing to become AI-first organisations

What they do: India's top IT companies have pivoted their entire service model around AI. Infosys's Topaz AI platform offers 150+ AI solutions for enterprise clients. Wipro's AI Studio

enables clients to deploy AI across manufacturing, BFSI, and healthcare. TCS's AI.Cloud helps enterprises integrate AI with existing infrastructure.

Business impact: India's IT sector employs 5.4 million people and generates \$250B+ in revenue. Their ability to deploy AI at scale across global enterprise clients makes them critical AI enablers for the entire economy.

SuperAGI (India) superagi.com

India's leading agentic AI platform for enterprise automation

What they do: SuperAGI builds autonomous AI agents that handle multi-step business workflows — from sales research and lead generation to code deployment and content production. Their platform enables enterprises to deploy AI agents that work continuously without human intervention.

Business impact: Raised funding from global investors. Enables IT firms and consultancies to offer agentic AI deployment services to enterprise clients — a market growing at over 40% annually.



The Question for Your Business

How much of your firm's intellectual capital is trapped in email threads, old decks, and project folders that nobody searches? AI knowledge management turns that buried expertise into a competitive asset that every consultant can access — instantly, with citations.

10 | Oil & Energy Sectors

The Big Picture

The energy sector operates on thin margins, massive infrastructure, and catastrophic downside risk. A single unplanned equipment failure on an oil rig can cost \$500,000 per day in downtime. A grid failure affecting millions has economic consequences measured in billions. AI does not just improve energy operations — it fundamentally changes their risk profile.

What AI Is Doing Right Now

- **Predictive Maintenance:** AI analyses sensor data from turbines, pumps, compressors, and pipelines — predicting failures days or weeks before they happen. Shell uses AI predictive maintenance across its global oil and gas operations, reducing downtime and improving safety.
- **Grid Optimisation:** AI balances electricity supply and demand in real time across millions of connection points — integrating renewable energy sources that fluctuate with weather into a stable grid.
- **Seismic Data Analysis:** AI processes geophysical data to identify new oil and gas deposits with greater accuracy and lower exploration cost than traditional methods.
- **Safety & HSE Monitoring:** AI-powered computer vision monitors worksites for unsafe behaviours, missing PPE, and hazardous conditions — alerting supervisors in real time before accidents occur.

- **Energy Consumption Optimisation:** AI continuously optimises energy use across manufacturing plants, commercial buildings, and industrial facilities — reducing electricity bills by 15–30%.
- **Battery Intelligence:** AI models optimise battery management for EVs and grid-scale storage — extending battery life and improving performance for energy storage applications.

Real Companies Doing It

Shell [shell.com](https://www.shell.com)

AI-driven predictive maintenance across global oil and gas operations

What they do: Shell has implemented AI for predictive maintenance in its oil and gas operations globally. AI sensor networks monitor equipment health in real time, predicting failures before they cause downtime. Shell also uses AI for supply chain optimisation and energy trading decisions.

Business impact: Reduces unplanned downtime significantly across offshore and onshore operations. Their AI implementation is cited by industry analysts as one of the most comprehensive in the oil and gas sector.

General Electric (GE) [ge.com](https://www.ge.com)

AI-powered monitoring for jet engines, turbines, and power infrastructure

What they do: GE deploys AI to monitor their jet engines and industrial turbines, predicting maintenance needs before issues arise. Their Predix platform connects industrial equipment to AI analytics, enabling real-time performance monitoring across power generation, aviation, and healthcare.

Business impact: GE's AI maintenance platform enhances reliability and safety for some of the world's most critical infrastructure. Their AI models process data from millions of sensors across global fleets.

Coulomb AI (India — YC Backed) [coulombai.com](https://www.coulombai.com)

AI for battery optimisation and next-generation energy storage

What they do: Coulomb AI builds AI-powered software that significantly improves battery lifespan and performance through predictive analytics, real-time monitoring, and adaptive battery management algorithms. Their technology is critical for India's EV transition and grid-scale energy storage.

Business impact: Addresses one of India's most pressing energy challenges: making EV batteries last longer and perform better. Their AI reduces battery degradation — a key factor in EV total cost of ownership.

The Question for Your Business

If you manage industrial equipment or energy infrastructure — do you have a number for how much your last unplanned downtime event cost? Most operators cannot answer that question precisely. AI predictive maintenance systems can give you that number in real time — and prevent the next event entirely.



BONUS | Fashion & Creative Industries

The Big Picture

Fashion moves at the speed of culture. AI now moves at the speed of the internet. Trend cycles that once took 6 months to identify and produce can now be identified in days and visualised in hours. For designers, D2C fashion brands, and jewellery makers, AI is eliminating the gap between inspiration and production.

What AI Is Doing Right Now

- **AI Fashion Design Tools:** Designers describe a concept in natural language or upload mood boards — AI generates garment designs, fabric patterns, and style variations in minutes.
- **Virtual Try-On:** Customers see how clothing, jewellery, and accessories look on their body type before purchase — reducing return rates by 20–40% for fashion e-commerce brands.
- **Trend Forecasting:** AI analyses runway shows, social media, street photography, and search data to predict which styles will peak 3–6 months ahead — enabling smarter procurement decisions.
- **AI Product Photography:** Fashion brands generate professional-quality product photos in any setting, on any model type, without a photographer or physical shoot.
- **Personalised Style Recommendations:** AI acts as a personal stylist for every customer — suggesting complete outfits based on body type, occasion, past purchases, and current inventory.

Real Companies Doing It

Ambaram AI — Fashion Design Platform app.ambaram.ai/plans

AI-powered fashion design and creative assistance for designers and brands

What they do: Ambaram AI is a specialised AI platform for fashion designers and creative professionals. Their tools assist with design ideation, pattern generation, styling concepts, and creative workflows — bringing the power of AI specifically to the fashion and lifestyle industry.

Business impact: Enables independent designers and small fashion brands to produce design variations and concepts at agency-level output without agency-level cost. Particularly relevant for India's growing D2C fashion ecosystem.



The Question for Your Business

If you are in fashion or design — how many concepts did your team explore before your last collection? AI tools can generate 100 design variations from a single brief in 30 minutes. That is not replacing your designer's taste. It is giving them 100 starting points instead of zero.



INDIA'S AI MOMENT

Why India Is at the Centre of the Global AI Story

In February 2026, India hosted the first global AI summit in the Global South — the India AI Impact Summit. The event triggered \$200 billion in investment commitments and announced India as a sovereign AI nation. This is not hype. It is the result of a decade of infrastructure investment, talent development, and a government that moved decisively.

Indicator	India's AI Position (2026)
Government Investment	₹10,000 crore IndiaAI Mission (potentially doubling to ₹20,000 crore)
Private Funding	Indian AI startups raised \$3.24 billion in 2024 — up 41% year-on-year
First Unicorn	Krutrim AI — founded by Bhavish Aggarwal, valued at \$1 billion+
Sovereign AI Model	Sarvam AI's 105 billion parameter model outperforms global models in Indic languages
Global Interest	Sam Altman, Sundar Pichai, and Dario Amodei all spoke at India AI Summit 2026
Market Projection	India's AI market projected to reach \$17 billion by 2027 at 25–35% CAGR

Key Indian AI Companies by Sector

Industry	Leading Indian AI Companies
Healthcare	Qure.ai, Niramai, SigTuple, Neodocs, Practo AI
Banking & Fintech	Arya.ai, Signzy, Gnani.ai, Perfios, Setu (Pine Labs)
Logistics & Supply Chain	Locus, Shippy, FarEye, Shadowfax AI
Customer Engagement	Yellow.ai, Haptik (Reliance), Uniphore
Agriculture	CropIn, Intello Labs, DeHaat AI
Edtech	BYJU's AI, Classplus, Unstop
Legal Tech	SpotDraft, Leegality, LawRato AI
HR & People	Fabric AI, Darwinbox, peopleHum
Construction	Attentive.ai (Beam AI), Supervise.ly
Foundational AI	Krutrim, Sarvam AI, CoRover, Ringg AI



The Indian Advantage

India has three things no other AI ecosystem has combined: 1.4 billion potential users, 22 official languages creating massive NLP opportunity, and the world's largest pool of engineering talent at competitive cost. The AI companies built for India will eventually serve the entire Global South.

Quick Reference: AI by Job Role

Regardless of your industry, if you hold one of the following roles, AI is already changing how your peers work. Here is what the best are doing with it.

Your Role	The Top 3 AI Applications Right Now
CEO / Founder	Market intelligence briefings. Board report generation. Strategic scenario modelling.
CFO / Finance Head	Automated variance analysis. Vendor risk scoring. Real-time budget vs actuals.
CMO / Marketing Head	AI content at scale. Audience micro-segmentation. Campaign performance prediction.
Sales Director	AI lead scoring. Call intelligence and coaching. Automated proposal generation.
HR Director	AI-powered CV screening. Attrition prediction. Automated onboarding workflows.
Operations Head	Predictive maintenance. Supply chain risk forecasting. Process automation.
Legal / Compliance	Contract review and red-flagging. Regulatory change monitoring. Due diligence.
Product Manager	Customer feedback synthesis. Competitive intelligence. Feature prioritisation AI.
IT / CTO	AI code generation. Security anomaly detection. Infrastructure cost optimisation.
Consultant / Analyst	Document intelligence. Automated research synthesis. Client report generation.

The AI Tools Every Business Professional Should Know

General Intelligence & Productivity

Tool	Best For
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Claude (Anthropic)	Document analysis, research, writing, coding, agentic workflows — the most capable professional AI
ChatGPT (OpenAI)	General tasks, image generation, broad creative work — most familiar to non-technical users
Google Gemini	Integration with Google Workspace, large document processing, multimodal tasks
NotebookLM (Google)	Deep research across your own documents — cited answers, audio overviews, mind maps
Perplexity AI	Real-time web research with citations — better than Google for professional research queries

Image & Visual AI

Tool	Best For
Nano Banana (Google)	Professional image editing and generation from text prompts — product photography, campaigns
Midjourney	High-quality creative and artistic image generation — brand imagery, concept visualisation
Adobe Firefly	Brand-safe commercial image generation integrated with the Adobe Creative Suite
Runway ML	AI video generation and editing — social content, product demos, ad creation

Voice & Automation

Tool	Best For
VAPI	Building AI voice agents for sales, customer support, and lead qualification — 24/7, multilingual
ElevenLabs	Realistic AI voiceover and voice cloning for videos, podcasts, and brand content
OpenClaw	Personal AI agent that autonomously handles tasks on your computer — email, calendar, research
n8n / Make.com	No-code workflow automation connecting AI tools to your existing business systems

Where Do You Start?

Every business professional who reads this handbook asks the same question: 'This is impressive — but where do I begin?' The answer is simpler than you think. You do not need to transform your entire

organisation overnight. You need one win. One use case where AI saves your team meaningful time or creates meaningful new capability.

The 30-Day AI Starter Plan

Week	Action
Week 1	Pick one repetitive task your team does every week that takes 2+ hours. Describe it to Claude or ChatGPT and ask it to do it. Measure the time saved.
Week 2	Identify your most important knowledge asset — a document, report, or research base. Upload it to NotebookLM and spend 30 minutes asking it questions. Notice what you learn.
Week 3	Find one customer-facing touchpoint — email, support, or social — where AI content can help. Generate 5 variations of one piece of content. Test which performs best.
Week 4	Share what worked with 2 colleagues. Run a 1-hour session showing them what you discovered. The best AI adoption in organisations is peer-to-peer, not top-down.

The Final Word

In 5 years, every business will be using AI. The only question is whether they are using it reactively — because they had to — or proactively — because they chose to move first. The businesses in this handbook moved first. They are not smarter than you. They are earlier. You still have that window. Use it.

Industry-Ready AI Handbook

A resource from the ET Masterclass: AI for Business Professionals

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